

In this chapter, we'll create a repo for a module named `wizcoin`, which handles the galleon, sickle, and knut coins of a fictional wizarding currency. The `cookiecutter` module uses templates to create the starting files for several different kinds of projects. Often, the template is simply a *GitHub.com* link. For example, from a `C:\Users\Al` folder, you could enter the following in a Terminal window to create a `C:\Users\Al\wizcoin` folder with the boilerplate files for a basic Python project. The `cookiecutter` module downloads the template from GitHub and asks you a series of questions about the project you want to create:

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```
C:\Users\Al>cookiecutter gh:asweigart/cookiecutter-basicpythonproject
project_name [Basic Python Project]: WizCoin
module_name [basicpythonproject]: wizcoin
author_name [Susie Softwaredeveloper]: Al Sweigart
author_email [susie@example.com]: al@inventwithpython.com
github_username [susieexample]: asweigart
project_version [0.1.0]:
project_short_description [A basic Python project.]: A Python module to represent
the galleon, sickle, and knut coins of wizard currency.
```

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If you get an error, you can also run `python -m cookiecutter` instead of `cookiecutter`. This command downloads a template I've created from <https://github.com/asweigart/cookiecutter-basicpythonproject>. You'll find templates for many programming languages at <https://github.com/cookiecutter/cookiecutter>. Because Cookiecutter templates are often hosted on GitHub, you could also enter `gh:` as a shortcut for `https://github.com/` in the command line argument.

As Cookiecutter asks you questions, you can either enter a response or simply press ENTER to use the default response shown in between square brackets. For example, `project_name [Basic Python Project]:` asks you to name your project. If you enter nothing, Cookiecutter will use “Basic Python Project” as the project name. These defaults also hint at what sort of response is expected. The `project_name [Basic Python Project]:` prompt shows you a capitalized project name that includes spaces, whereas the `module_name [basicpythonproject]:` prompt shows you that the module name is lowercase and has no spaces. We didn't enter a response for the `project_version [0.1.0]:` prompt, so the response defaults to “0.1.0.”